



Fig. 2: Dimmer

System requirement

Operating system:

- Windows 8 (32-bit and 64-bit)
- Windows 7 (32-bit and 64-bit)
- Windows Vista
- Windows XP
- Windows 2000
- Linux (using Wine)

How to install?

Double-click on the executable file *splan70(demo).exe* (or right-click on the file and select *Run as administrator* for Windows Vista users) to run the installation.

The installation wizard window that opens will help you set up the program on your computer.

NB: The demo version of sPlan 7.0 has saving, exporting and printing disabled.

sub-circuit or module on a separate page. These pages are saved as individual files to enable sharing between different projects. You can also copy, delete, sort, rename and change properties of individual pages in one project itself. Swapping between pages is also made possible easily by clicking on the required page name from the ones displayed under the workspace.

Grid. Grid distance can be defined by the user. Moreover, the components (dragged-and-dropped) and connections are automatically inclined and positioned in the grid. One can also move, shear, rotate and scale individu-

al components or group of components in the grids.

Import/export. One can open, modify or design, and create files with the extension *.spl using sPlan. Multiple pages in a single project can be saved individually, making it possible to exchange individual pages between multiple projects. It is also possible to export schematics to other common formats like JPG, GIF, BMP, EMF and SVG.

Components list. Another important feature of sPlan is that it automatically creates and updates a components list for each page, selected pages or a whole project. This list can be opened, edited, sorted (both alphabetically and quantitatively), copied, printed, saved (in *.rtf) and exported or imported (to and from Excel file).

Numbering. Automatic renumbering of components is yet another feature of sPlan. In case one of the components have to be deleted, by using the renumbering function all the components can be indexed automatically and logically, depending on the pattern you want—row-wise or column-wise.

Zoom. The zoom function lets you get a bird's eyeview of the circuit or each part or component. This is achieved by either clicking the zoom icon or rolling the mouse wheel. It is possible to zoom in/out the page, its elements or any specific element in the diagram.

Magnetic line. This is just a circuit

construction aid that helps identify correct positions when objects are moved. When elements are moved near magnetic lines, they are automatically aligned to them.

Form. This is a layer that lies under the original circuit diagram that displays the properties of each page. New forms can be added and existing ones can be edited by the user. Form layers can be saved individually in *.sbk format and called into any page according to need.

Help. sPlan has a built-in simple and extensive help section, which makes it easier for first-time users to understand the software functions.

Others. Features like automatic component numbering, component search, and external and internal linking functions further reduce the complexity and increase the speed of this software. Schematic files created with older versions of sPlan are compatible with the new sPlan 7.0.

Support

Free help and support for the software can be obtained from ABACOM by sending an email to abacom.del@t-online.de. All the latest updates and bug fixes are published on their website—www.abacom-online.de/uk/. The site also provides free download of additional libraries created by other users and lets you submit a library of components created by you that could be useful to others.

The company also sells other tools like Sprint-Layout 6.0 (PCB layout software), LochMaster 4.0 (for designing, developing and testing strip board projects), FrontDesigner 3.0 (designing front panels for electronics products), ProfiLab 4.0 (designing digital control for analogue measuring technology), RealView 3.0 (recording and plotting measurements in real time) and AudioWave 2.0 (a low-frequency signal generator software.) Apart from these software products, the firm also sells hardware and bundles related to the software tools. ●

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